



Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies plans and policies

Kenya Appoints Martin Koyabe as Inaugural Chair of National Cybersecurity Agency — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 KENYA

Kenya has named Dr Martin Koyabe the inaugural non-executive chairperson of the board of its National Cybersecurity Agency, announced by ICT and Digital Economy principal secretary John Tanui, who set the new agency against the government's stated ambition to grow the digital economy to 30% of GDP. No other board member, budget or commencement date is named. *Also under [Cybersecurity](#).*

Kenya and US Business Community Deepen Cooperation on Digital Economy and AI — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 KENYA

Kenya's ICT cabinet secretary received an American Chamber of Commerce delegation to discuss deeper cooperation on artificial intelligence, digital skills, cybersecurity, data governance and cross-border data flows. He pressed for training programmes that end in certification and employment rather than in courses, and pointed to a September summit as the place where the discussion would become commitments. Nothing was signed, and no target, budget or timeline was set. *Also under [US / hyperscaler activities](#) and [AI](#).*

Ghana and Malawi Strengthen Digital Transformation Cooperation Through Knowledge Sharing — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 GHANA MALAWI

A Malawian delegation led by deputy chief secretary Stuart Ligomeka took a study tour of Ghana's Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations, where deputy minister Mohammed Adams Sukparu presented Ghana's work on digital infrastructure, digital identity, cybersecurity, e-government, digital skills and innovation ecosystems. Ligomeka described Ghana as an important reference point for Malawi's own digital transformation and both sides proposed sustained cooperation between their technical teams; no instrument was signed and no programme, budget or timeline was announced. *Also under [Regional collaboration](#) and [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*

Legislation and regulation

SpaceX appeals to South Africa's regulator — Advanced Television, 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

SpaceX appeared before an ICASA panel on the draft amendments to South Africa's spectrum and spectrum-fee regulations gazetted on 15 May, calling the consultation a marked improvement on the existing regime while pressing the regulator over its delay in licensing the operator. Its pointed request was that ICASA say how the

minimum 30% equity stake for historically disadvantaged groups applies to the new gateway and user-terminal licence categories. The source dates the hearing only as “last week”, which places it in the week of 17–21 August without establishing a day. *Also under [Connectivity](#) and [US / hyperscaler activities](#).*

Nigeria SEC toughens crypto rules — ITWeb Africa, 24 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria's Securities and Exchange Commission has issued draft rules setting minimum capital at N500 million for digital asset platform operators and real-world asset tokenisation platforms and N200 million for virtual asset service providers, on a N30 million registration fee and a fidelity insurance bond covering at least a quarter of paid-up capital. Operators serving Nigerian residents would have to be locally incorporated with a resident top executive, and no digital asset business could target the market without SEC approval. The article's headline figure of \$1.41m does not reconcile with the naira amounts it goes on to give, and is not repeated here. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

MTN expects Nigeria rebound as airtime lending resumes — TechCabal, 24 August 2026

NIGERIA

MTN Nigeria has resumed airtime lending, suspended in April when the consumer watchdog brought the service under new licensing and consumer-protection requirements. The operator restarted on four vendors with its lending base cut to about a quarter of the first-quarter run rate, at a stated cost of around 50 billion naira (US\$37.1m) to first-half revenue, and expects the whitelisted customer base to rebuild through the second half. The jurisdictional dispute the suspension turned on — whether airtime credit is telecoms or consumer lending — is still before the Court of Appeal. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [ICT Industry](#).*

Kenya's crypto party is over. Now comes the compliance bill. — TechCabal, 24 August 2026

KENYA

An assessment of what Kenya's new virtual asset regime will cost the firms it covers, arguing that licence fees are the smaller part of it beside capital, ring-fencing, audit, cybersecurity and specialist staff. Thresholds are low or absent at the specialist end — no minimum paid-up capital for virtual asset investment advisors, KES 10 million for tokenisation providers, KES 20 million for asset managers and ICO providers — so smaller local firms have a way in while stablecoin issuers and offshore platforms face the heaviest requirements and the closest scrutiny. Businesses have until 4 November to transition. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

Data protection

Africa's data sovereignty push is reshaping the AI race, and AWS wants in — TechCabal, 24 August 2026

NIGERIA

KENYA

SOUTH AFRICA

AWS is pitching a sovereign-by-design cloud to African enterprises as localisation rules tighten around where data may be held — Nigeria's central bank on payments, South Africa's data and cloud policy, Kenya's civil-registration rules and Rwanda's financial and telecoms requirements. Its executive in residence told a Johannesburg summit on 19 August that the company complies with the laws of the hundred-plus countries it operates in. The trade-off is cost: in-country hosting can cut latency below 15 milliseconds but is dearer where power is unreliable, and hybrid arrangements deepen rather than reduce dependence on the same platforms. *Also under [AI](#) and [Data Storage](#).*

Regional collaboration

Ghana and Malawi Strengthen Digital Transformation Cooperation Through Knowledge Sharing — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026

GHANA

MALAWI

Summarised under [Strategies plans and policies](#).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Data Is Botswana's New Diamond — Taavi Erkkola (LinkedIn Pulse), 24 August 2026

BOTSWANA

A named-analyst argument that Statistics Botswana is moving from custodian of data to active enabler of open data, on the evidence of its microdata portal, a move towards SDMX standards and a hackathon run with the Botswana Digital Innovation Hub and Team Europe. It is direct about what the office's own internal reviews found in the way — ambiguous legal language on the portals, non-commercial licensing clauses that disqualify datasets from counting as open, and departments with no incentive to publish timely structured data — and rests the case for urgency on youth unemployment that Statistics Botswana puts at 55.6% for 18-24 year-olds and 38.2% across 15-35. The piece carries no visible publication date and is dated here by retrieval. *Also under [Open data](#), [National statistics](#) and [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

Finance

New investments

Tech Credit Fund Backs Women-Owned Molotel's Expansion of Digital Connectivity in South Africa — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

A private credit platform has extended a structured debt facility of undisclosed size to Molotel, a wholly women-owned South African internet service provider holding both service and network licences from the regulator. The money funds continued fibre, wireless, LTE and hybrid rollout into underserved metropolitan and township areas across five provinces. *Also under [Connectivity](#).*

Stellar x CV Labs Accelerator : trois fintechs africaines selectionnees — wearetech.africa, 24 August 2026

Three African payment firms have been selected for a twelve-week accelerator run by the Stellar foundation, offering training, expert advice and funding of up to US\$150,000 to build out cross-border payment and remittance platforms. The figure is a ceiling rather than a commitment, and the countries the three operate in are not named. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

New capital quadruples Frogfoot's fibre rollout — ITWeb South Africa, 24 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

New investors have subscribed for shares in South African fibre network operator Frogfoot and its Vivica Group sister companies Vox and Hypa, in a transaction implying a combined after-debt equity value of R8.4 billion, with the DNI Consortium the largest shareholder grouping and RMB adviser and funder. The stated purpose is to quadruple Frogfoot's connection rate to 360,000 homes a year within twelve months, aimed at townships and lower-income communities and claimed to create more than 5,000 direct jobs. No subscription amount is disclosed, so the R8.4 billion is a valuation rather than the capital committed. *Also under [Connectivity](#) and [Digital divides](#).*

Blockradar Hits \$1 Billion in Transaction Volume as Stablecoin Infrastructure Scales — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026

Stablecoin infrastructure provider Blockradar says it has processed more than US\$1 billion in transaction volume, supporting hundreds of fintech businesses across more than 20 countries. The company puts the use cases at cross-border supplier payments, remittances and conversion between stablecoins and local currencies. The figure is the company's own and no country breakdown is given. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

Askya wants to build 'tech Dangotes' starting with 10 African AI startups — TechCabal, 24 August 2026

Askya Investment Partners has opened applications for a six-week programme for ten African AI startups, with a minimum commitment of US\$200,000 to at least one participant and no cash fee or equity required to take part. Its founder, previously at Proparco's venture programme and chief executive of Digital Africa, distinguishes it from an accelerator on the grounds that accelerators are built to end in a fundraise. *Also under [AI](#).*

AMAN and noon Egypt Partner to Expand Digital Financing for Online Shoppers — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 EGYPT

AMAN Consumer Finance has agreed to integrate its consumer credit as a direct payment option on noon's Egyptian e-commerce platform, letting approved customers finance purchases at checkout against an existing credit limit. AMAN says it runs over 150,000 payment points nationwide. No deal value, volume or timetable is published. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

84 M&A deals worth \$11.4 billion in disclosed value recorded so far in 2026 — TechCabal, 24 August 2026

A trade researcher counted 84 mergers and acquisitions in Africa's digital economy worth an estimated US\$11.4 billion in disclosed value between 1 January and 17 August, past the 68 recorded across the whole of 2025. Financial services led on 27 deals and the targets clustered in South Africa, Nigeria and Egypt, with MTN Group's proposed US\$6.2bn purchase of 75% of IHS Towers the largest disclosed value. Set against US\$1.44 billion raised by startups in the first half, the exit route is now larger than the entry one; the count is disclosed value only. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Top ICT tenders: Inmates to get telecoms upgrade — ITWeb South Africa, 24 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's correctional service has put a fifteen-year contract out to tender for an inmate communication system across 243 centres, replacing copper telephony it says has deteriorated beyond support for about 166,000 prisoners. The winning supplier would design, install, integrate, operate and maintain it and tie it to the inmate cash system so airtime is bought from prisoners' own balances, with monitoring, recording, data storage and compliance in scope. No contract value is published and bids close on 14 September. *Also under [Other GovTech and e-Gov](#).*

Tanzania President Mwinyi Reviews TTCL's Digital Connectivity Expansion in Zanzibar — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 TANZANIA

Zanzibar's president Hussein Ali Mwinyi was briefed on TTCL's connectivity work at the state operator's pavilion during the Kizimkazi Festival, covering the National ICT Broadband Backbone's rollout across the islands, the Faiba Mlangoni Kwako fibre-to-the-home service and the National Internet Data Centre's cloud and colocation offering. It is a courtesy visit rather than an announcement: no new investment, target or date is attached to any of it. *Also under [Rural digital data capture](#).*

MTN is finding its next growth engine outside South Africa — TechCabal, 24 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

NIGERIA

MTN's first-half 2026 results put group service revenue up 17.5% in constant currency to R115.3 billion, with the growth concentrated away from home: Ghana, Nigeria, Uganda, Côte d'Ivoire and Cameroon were among the strongest contributors while South Africa managed 1.5%. Data revenue rose 29.2% against 2.4% for voice, the

customer base reached 317.7 million, and almost R20 billion of capital expenditure was committed in the half. Nigeria is guided to at least low-20% service-revenue growth and Ghana to the mid-to-upper 30s, against low-to-mid single digits in South Africa. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [ICT Industry](#).*

MTN Group Limited – Financial results for the six months ended 30 June 2026 – MTN Group Limited (JSE SENS), 24 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

NIGERIA

GHANA

UGANDA

CÔTE D'IVOIRE

CAMEROON

MTN's own half-year booklet settles a figure its two trade-press accounts disagreed on: active data subscribers rose 9.1% to 179.3 million, not 10.3%, which is the growth in wholesale revenue on the same page. Fintech is the line the group leads on – 13.0 billion transactions in the half carrying US\$330.5 billion, up 33.8% in constant currency, on 70.8 million monthly active mobile-money users. Group service revenue was R115.3 billion, up 17.5% in constant currency, with the gains concentrated outside the home market. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [ICT Industry](#).*

Internet : le Nigeria choisit IAI et Thales Alenia Space pour acquérir deux nouveaux satellites – wearetech.africa, 24 August 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria's Federal Executive Council has approved the acquisition of two high-throughput communications satellites, NIGCOMSAT-2A and 2B, to be built by Thales Alenia Space and Israel Aerospace Industries. The operator puts 2A in orbit by the end of 2028 and 2B in 2029 or 2030. The award breaks with the Chinese partnership behind NigComSat-1, which failed within eighteen months of its 2007 launch, and NigComSat-1R, now near the end of its design life; no contract value is published and negotiation precedes manufacture. *Also under [Use of satellite data](#).*

FiberOne expands to seven Nigerian states, steps up community investment – BusinessDay NG, 24 August 2026

NIGERIA

FiberOne Broadband says it will extend its fibre network into Abeokuta, Edo, Ondo, Delta, Kano and Kaduna before the end of 2026, adding to a footprint in Lagos, Abuja, Port Harcourt, Ilorin and Ibadan. The rollout is paired with community works in Lagos, a free engineering training academy that offers its best trainees employment, and a schools connectivity programme rising from 10 schools in 2025 to 30 in 2026. *Also under [Digital divides](#) and [Training and skills](#).*

FiberHome tour targets Kenyan 6G – ITWeb Africa, 24 August 2026

KENYA

At the Nairobi leg of FiberHome's world tour, Kenya's principal secretary for broadcasting and telecommunications Stephen Isaboke said the country would deepen its partnership with the Wuhan-headquartered vendor, citing specialised training for Kenyan students and plans for an East African research and development centre, and framing the work against satellite connectivity, all-optical networks and an eventual move to 6G. FiberHome has operated in Kenya since 2017 and has built segments of the 100,000-kilometre Digital Superhighway; no target, budget or timeline is attached to the intent stated here. *Also under [ICT Industry](#) and [China activities](#).*

Cell C Reports ZAR 4.16 Billion Profit as Turnaround Gains Strengthen FY26 Performance – Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

Cell C reported profit after tax of ZAR 4.16 billion for the year to 31 May 2026, on total revenue of ZAR 12.64 billion and service revenue of ZAR 11.64 billion, with earnings per share of 2,338 cents. Prepaid service revenue grew 9.7% to ZAR 5.51 billion past 8 million subscribers and wholesale revenue 20% to ZAR 1.65 billion as the MVNO base reached 5.71 million; free cash flow was ZAR 1.06 billion. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

Tech Credit Fund Backs Women-Owned Molotel's Expansion of Digital Connectivity in South Africa — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [New investments](#).

SpaceX appeals to South Africa's regulator — Advanced Television, 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

New capital quadruples Frogfoot's fibre rollout — ITWeb South Africa, 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [New investments](#).

Data Storage

Africa's data sovereignty push is reshaping the AI race, and AWS wants in — TechCabal, 24 August 2026

NIGERIA

KENYA

SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Data protection](#).

Technical Capacity

Cause of breach on SA's supercomputer revealed — ITWeb South Africa, 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's science minister told the National Assembly that the late-May breach of the Lengau supercomputer was caused by vulnerabilities in the legacy high-performance computing system, with unauthorised access to parts of the environment and crypto-currency mining malware deployed. Ageing components are technically constrained or no longer fully supported by their vendors, and a remediation programme covering access controls, privileged-access management, network segmentation, patching and monitoring has since run. No cost, data-loss finding or outage duration is stated, and the same centre was reported at maximum capacity earlier in the month. *Also under [Cybersecurity](#).*

Cybersecurity

Kenya Appoints Martin Koyabe as Inaugural Chair of National Cybersecurity Agency — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 KENYA

Summarised under [Strategies plans and policies](#).

Cause of breach on SA's supercomputer revealed — ITWeb South Africa, 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Technical Capacity](#).

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

Fayda digital ID nears 50M enrollments as adoption reshapes Ethiopia's economy — Biometric Update, 24 August 2026 ETHIOPIA

Ethiopia's Fayda digital ID reached 49.1 million enrolments by 24 August, on 12,000 biometric registration kits deployed and 150 agencies integrated, with more than 194 million eKYC verifications recorded. The prime minister's expectation that the credential will contribute 7% of GDP by 2030 is stated alongside those counts as a projection. The figures are the programme's own and unaudited; its enrolment target is 90 million by 2028. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

Digital Payments and Fintech

MTN MoMo Equips 1,225 South Sudanese Entrepreneurs With Digital Finance Skills — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

1,225 South Sudanese entrepreneurs have graduated from a year-long digital financial literacy programme run by MTN MoMo with Inkomoko, which paired business guidance and seed funding with training in accepting digital payments, selling airtime and providing cash-in services. UNHCR, the National Chamber of Commerce, the Mastercard Foundation and the Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation were represented at the graduation. *Also under [Training and skills](#) and [Digital divides](#).*

MTN Group fintech transactions hit \$330bn — ITWeb Africa, 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA NIGERIA GHANA

MTN Group's fintech transaction value reached \$330.5 billion in the six months to June 2026, up 33.8% in constant currency, on volumes up 17% to 13 billion across 1.4 million active agents and 2.3 million merchants. Advanced services grew 31.8% to make up 37.4% of MoMo revenue, offsetting flatter cash-out and peer-to-peer activity and the suspension of airtime advance in Nigeria, which the group expects to reinstate through four newly onboarded providers. Alongside the results MTN advanced a R6 billion share buyback and its purchase of the rest of IHS Holdings, to close in the second half with 30% of IHS Nigeria sold down to local investors. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

Nigeria SEC toughens crypto rules — ITWeb Africa, 24 August 2026 NIGERIA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

MTN is finding its next growth engine outside South Africa — TechCabal, 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA NIGERIA

Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

MTN Group Limited — Financial results for the six months ended 30 June 2026 — MTN Group Limited (JSE SENS), 24 August 2026 SOUTH AFRICA NIGERIA GHANA UGANDA CÔTE D'IVOIRE CAMEROON

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MTN expects Nigeria rebound as airtime lending resumes — TechCabal, 24 August 2026 NIGERIA

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Kenya's crypto party is over. Now comes the compliance bill. — TechCabal, 24 August 2026 KENYA

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Fayda digital ID nears 50M enrollments as adoption reshapes Ethiopia's economy — Biometric Update, 24 August 2026 ETHIOPIA

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Blockradar Hits \$1 Billion in Transaction Volume as Stablecoin Infrastructure Scales — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026

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Other GovTech and e-Gov

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Summarised under [Strategies plans and policies](#).

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Tanzania President Mwinyi Reviews TTCL's Digital Connectivity Expansion in Zanzibar — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026 TANZANIA

Summarised under [Connectivity](#).

Technology

AI

Christine Imoukhuede utilise l'IA pour structurer l'événementiel — wearetech.africa, 24 August 2026 NIGERIA

A trade-press profile of Christine Imoukhuede, the Nigerian accountant who founded Ahavaplan in 2021 to run event management on a single platform covering budget, calendar, tasks and documentation. Its assistant drafts proposals, builds schedules and shortlists suppliers, with the founder's pitch resting on automating administration rather than replacing the organiser. *Also under [Innovation ecosystem](#).*

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Africa's data sovereignty push is reshaping the AI race, and AWS wants in — TechCabal, 24 August 2026

NIGERIA KENYA SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Data protection](#).

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Innovation ecosystem

Standard Chartered Foundation Launches Women in Tech Accelerator in Egypt — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026

EGYPT

Standard Chartered Foundation, Entlaq and Village Capital have opened a second Egyptian cohort of their Women in Tech Accelerator, taking 12 women-led technology start-ups through investment-readiness training and mentorship, with USD 35,000 in equity-free grants to be split between three of them at the close. The 2025 first cohort drew 240 applications and backed 11 start-ups; Entlaq's Women in Entrepreneurship Report 2025 puts the funding gap facing Egyptian women founders at an estimated USD 2.2 billion. *Also under [Training and skills](#) and [Digital divides](#).*

Stellar x CV Labs Accelerator : trois fintechs africaines selectionnees — wearetech.africa, 24 August 2026

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NIGERIA

Summarised under [AI](#).

Capacity

Literacy

Airtel Launches Fursa Lab at Tanzania School to Boost Students' Digital Skills — Tech Africa News, 24 August 2026

TANZANIA

Airtel Africa Foundation and the Dar Teknohama Business Incubator have opened an Airtel Fursa Lab for digital skills and technology education at Kijitonyama Secondary School, launched by the foundation's head of programmes Esi Prah. No enrolment target, cost, equipment specification or timeline is attached to it. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*

Training and skills

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Summarised under [Innovation ecosystem](#).

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SOUTH SUDAN

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FiberOne expands to seven Nigerian states, steps up community investment — BusinessDay NG, 24 August 2026

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Inclusion

Digital divides

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TANZANIA

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Data

National statistics

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BOTSWANA

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Open data

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BOTSWANA

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Use of satellite data

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Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

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China activities

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.